K9 Movement — AI Image Generation Prompt Guide

Purpose: This document is the style bible for writing text-to-image prompts for K9 Movement. Any AI model or person generating photography-style images for the brand — whether it's a landscape background, a mascot portrait, or a client's dog — should follow this structure. It exists so that images generated months apart, by different people or different AI tools, still read as coming from the same camera.

---

1. The Philosophy Behind Every Rule

Athletic-performance photography usually oversells itself: neon color, maximum saturation, dramatic studio light, "extreme energy." It's a visual language so overused that the eye reads it as advertising before it reads it as real.

K9 Movement's photography works because it does the opposite — every image reads as **evidence, not advertising**. Desaturation and grain say "this was happening, not staged." The amber accent works because it's rare — it becomes the one thing in the frame that has energy inside a hostile, muted environment. Cold, neutral tones say "tool," not "lifestyle."

Every technical rule below exists to protect that effect. The moment a prompt asks for beauty, drama, or polish, it breaks the brand — even if it "looks nicer."

---

2. The Universal Prompt Skeleton

Every K9 Movement prompt is built from the same ordered blocks. Keep this order — it mirrors how the reference prompts are structured and makes prompts easy to audit at a glance.

1. **Opening descriptor** — one sentence, shot type + purpose + subject hierarchy
2. **COMPOSICIÓN** — exact framing, placement, proportions
3. **CAMERA / LENS / FOCAL LENGTH / APERTURE** — fixed technical kit
4. **LIGHTING** — the fixed backlight formula
5. **COLOR GRADE** — the fixed 4-value palette
6. **TEXTURA** — grain and detail behavior (optional but recommended)
7. **WHAT TO AVOID** — negative list
8. **FINAL FEEL** — one closing sentence, plain language

---

3. Section-by-Section Rules

Opening descriptor

Formula: *"[Cinematic] + [shot type] + photograph[, exact pixel dimensions if the piece has a fixed format]."* Follow with one sentence stating what the image is **for** (a slide background, a brand material, a portrait), and one sentence stating who or what **owns the frame**.

> "Cinematic wide landscape photograph. A dense Canadian forest... This is primarily a landscape photograph designed as a full-bleed background for a presentation slide.

> @angelk9 is a small detail within it, not the subject."

Composition

- Always state the subject's size as a **percentage of the frame** (10–15% for environmental/background shots; full head-and-chest crop for portraits).
- Always state **where** in the frame (which corner or third) and **why** — usually to leave clean negative space for typography overlay.
- Unless it's a true portrait, the subject is explicitly **not centered, not large**.
- For multi-subject frames, describe the relationship precisely: each subject self-contained, not touching, not making eye contact with each other or the camera, present in the same space without "interacting" for the camera.

Camera kit — two fixed modes, never mixed

Mode	Camera	Lens	Focal length	Aperture	When to use
Environmental / Landscape	Cinema 70mm Film	Anamorphic Classic	35mm	f/8	Full-bleed backgrounds, landscape-dominant shots, everything in focus foreground to background
Portrait / Close-up	Cinema Digital 35mm	Medium Format Planar	85mm	f/2	Close-up portraits, reference-pose matching, product or detail shots, shallow depth of field

Never combine specs from both columns in one prompt — this is what keeps "background" images and "portrait" images feeling like they were shot by the same photographer on two different lenses, not two different photographers.

Lighting formula (non-negotiable)

Always **late afternoon**, always **backlight from upper right**, always **amber-gold light breaking through canopy in shafts** (or, for portraits, as rim light). Never front-lit, never flat, never studio-even. State exactly what the light touches on the subject — ear tips, chest, spine, individual fur strands — this is what makes the lighting feel observed rather than generated.

Color grade — fixed palette, do not deviate

Zone	Value
Shadows	`#1A3F3B` → `#111111`
Forest mid-tones	`#3F7273` (desaturated teal-green)
Highlights / light shafts	`#EFA632` (amber-gold)
Crushed blacks	`#111111`

These four values are the **entire** palette, regardless of season, location, or subject. No warm golden-hour wash across the whole frame, no green foliage at natural saturation, no neutral grey shadow — everything routes through this grade.

Texture

Cinema 70mm film grain — fine but present throughout, heavier in the deep shadows. Physical detail (bark, leaves, roots, individual fur strands) sharp near the subject, softening toward the edges of the frame. Never clean or digitally smooth.

What to avoid — master checklist

- Subject centered or large in frame
- Bright, even, overall exposure
- Any human visible
- Any manicured or urban setting
- Bright elements in the zone reserved for typography
- Oversaturated color, neon, studio-flat light
- Golden-hour warmth applied to the *whole* frame (warmth belongs only in the highlights)
- **For animal subjects specifically:** alert or tense posture, direct eye contact with the camera, open mouth, any sense of being "posed" or "performing"

Final feel (closing line)

One plain sentence. No adjectives about beauty. It describes a fact or a moment, not a mood — reinforcing that the forest was there before the camera arrived.

> "A landscape that happens to have a dog resting in the corner. The forest is the story."
> "The forest has always been here. They found their spots in it a long time ago."

---

4. Subject-Specific Rules

Angel & Romeo (brand mascots)

Always use the identity tags `@angelk9` / `@romeok9`. Include the full **CRITICAL** coat block every time, so the model doesn't drift across generations:

Angel — uniform sandy golden short coat, no markings, no mask. Large, fully erect triangular ears — even lying down, the ears stay upright; this is her single most identifying feature from any angle. **Pink collar** *(confirmed by Emma in the most recent call — not present in the four reference prompts, add it to every Angel prompt going forward).*

Romeo — solid matte black upper body (back, skull, ears). White muzzle below eye level, small black spot on the nose bridge. Wide white chest patch extending down the abdomen. Front legs white from mid-leg down. Semi-folded ears — firm base, tip dropping forward. Short, dense, smooth coat. **Red collar** *(same update — add to every Romeo prompt going forward).*

Behavior, both: never performing, never posed. Settled into the environment long enough that it looks natural. If paired, they don't look at each other — each is present in their own world, aware of the other without showing it.

Non-mascot dogs (client dogs, breed variety)

Used for training-client content or stock variety beyond Angel and Romeo. These prompts typically:

- Match an existing reference image's exact pose (useful when the client supplies a photo of their own dog)
- Switch to **Portrait / Close-up** camera mode (85mm, f/2) rather than the landscape kit
- Still obey the same fixed **lighting** and **color grade** formula as every other K9 Movement image — breed and mode change, the light and grade never do

---

5. Fill-in Templates

A. Environmental / Background Template

```
Cinematic wide landscape photograph. A dense Canadian forest — eastern white pine and sugar maple, late afternoon light breaking through the canopy. This is primarily a landscape photograph designed as [PURPOSE]. [SUBJECT] is a small detail within it, not the subject.

COMPOSICIÓN: [SUBJECT] occupies the [CORNER] of the frame — approximately [%] of the total frame area. [POSE/ACTION DESCRIPTION]. The landscape owns the frame completely. The upper two thirds of the image is pure forest — dark, atmospheric, clean enough for [text color] text overlay on the [SIDE].

CAMERA: Cinema 70mm Film
LENS: Anamorphic Classic
FOCAL LENGTH: 35mm
APERTURE: f/8

LIGHTING: Late afternoon backlight from upper right — amber-gold light shafts cutting through the canopy. [What the light touches on the subject]. Shadows deep forest teal (#1A3F3B). Highlights amber-gold (#EFA632).

COLOR GRADE: Shadows (#1A3F3B to #111111). Forest mid-tones desaturated teal-green (#3F7273). Light shafts amber-gold (#EFA632). Upper portion of frame darkest — reserved for typography. Blacks crushed to #111111.

WHAT TO AVOID: [SUBJECT] centered or large in frame. Bright overall exposure. Any human visible. Any manicured setting. Any element in the upper two thirds competing with text overlay.

FINAL FEEL: [One plain, factual closing sentence].
```

B. Portrait / Close-up Template

```
Cinematic close-up portrait photograph. [SUBJECT DESCRIPTION AND POSE]. Tight crop from [CROP LINE]. [COAT/COLOR DESCRIPTION].

CAMERA: Cinema Digital 35mm
LENS: Medium Format Planar
FOCAL LENGTH: 85mm
APERTURE: f/2

LIGHTING AND GRADE: Hard backlight from upper right — amber-gold rim light tracing [WHERE ON SUBJECT]. Background: [environment], deep teal-green bokeh. Shadows (#1A3F3B). Highlights (#EFA632). Medium-dark exposure.
```

---

6. Pre-Send Checklist

Before sending any prompt to the image model, confirm:

- [ ] Opening line states purpose and who owns the frame
- [ ] Subject size is given as a percentage or explicit crop line
- [ ] Placement (corner/third) and the reason (typography space) are both stated
- [ ] Camera kit is one of the two fixed modes — not mixed
- [ ] Lighting is late-afternoon backlight from upper right
- [ ] Color grade uses only the four fixed hex values
- [ ] Angel/Romeo prompts include the full CRITICAL coat block, collar included
- [ ] "What to avoid" list is present, including the animal-specific items if applicable
- [ ] Closing line is one plain, factual sentence — no beauty adjectives